not advised for the aged, the fibre of tender vegetables, fruits will make easier the passage of the food down the intestinal tract. Fibre also helps in reducing cholesterol which may reduce the incidence of atherosclerosis.

4.2.3 Dietary guidelines

- Empty calorie foods should be taken minimum and calorie dense foods should be avoided.
- Foods rich in protein, vitamin and mineral should be included.
- Vegetables and fruits are good sources of antioxidants. A minimum of 5 servings should be taken.
- As fat promotes weight gain. Saturated fat should be limited.
- Gas forming foods like sulphur containing vegetables and certain type of pulses have to be avoided.
- Soft well cooked foods are preferred.
- Food should be less salty and spicy.
- Fried and concentrated foods should be avoided.
- Caffeine containing beverages should be limited, otherwise they may suffer from insomnia.
- High fibre diet including greens and whole grains are to be included in the diet.
- Easily digestible steam foods like idlies or idiyappam can be part of the diet.
- Plenty of fluids and semi solid foods should be taken.
- 2-3 servings of low fat milk should be included in the diet.
- Consumption of Omega 3 fatty acids may help in reducing hair loss, impairment of vision, improper digestion and tissue inflammation.
- Tobacco chewing, smoking betel leaves chewing are the habits which may affect consumption of food in the elderly, hence should be avoided.

4.2.4 Major nutrition related problems

a) Obesity

Obesity is two to three times as prevalent in women as in men. Associated with obesity is an increased incidents of diabetes.

b) Osteoporosis

Osteoporosis is characterized by a significant decrease in bone mass occurring when mineral loss proceeds at a faster rate than mineral deposit enduring bone



Fig 4.3 Symptoms of osteoporosis among adults

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